Rs 1,06,042 crore; from the non-financial group (dividend from public-sector enterprises and other investments), it was Rs 57,487 crore.

The actual performance was quite different. Despite most PSBs suffering from losses on account of provisions made for NPAs, the dividend and surplus transfers from the financial entities group was much higher at Rs 1,50,589 crore, whereas the non-financial public-sector enterprises and entities contributed only Rs 35,543 crore.

RBI contributed a sum of Rs 1,47,987 crore out of the dividend and surpluses of Rs 1,50,589 crore received from the financial entities group. This surplus transfer excluded the interim surplus amount of Rs 28,000 crore transferred in March 2019 from the surpluses of 2018–19. All other PSBs, LIC and general insurance companies contributed a meagre amount of Rs 2602 crore; in fact, this was almost entirely from LIC.

In 2017–18, transfers from RBI were only Rs 40,659 crore, inclusive of Rs 10,000 crore interim dividend. In the following year (2018–19), transfer from RBI rose to Rs 68,000 crore, inclusive of Rs 28,000 crore interim dividend. RBI had transferred Rs 52,679 crore, Rs 65,896 crore and Rs 65,876 crore in the previous three years of 2014–15, 2015–16 and 2016–17. What led to this massive jump in surplus transfer in 2020–21?

RBI earned income of Rs 1,93,000 crore in 2018–19 as against Rs 78,000 crore in 2017–18, an increase of Rs 1,15,000 crore. This was largely on account of massive movement in its four heads of income. First, RBI booked extraordinary profits by selling foreign exchange securities/reserves. In 2018–19, net foreign exchange reserves of over $25 billion were sold. As these securities are valued at average cost of acquisition, RBI booked a gain of Rs 28,998 crore under ‘exchange gain/loss from foreign exchange transactions’ as against a loss of Rs 4067 crore in 2017–18. Second, the central bank undertook a one-time revaluation of its foreign exchange assets and took Rs 52,618 crore to its income statement under the head ‘provision no longer required and